11-22 第一篇

Bees and Pollination: Small Insects, Big Impact

Bees are among the most important insects on Earth. They do not just make honey—they play a vital role in helping plants produce fruits, vegetables, and seeds. When a bee visits a flower to collect nectar and pollen, it accidentally carries pollen from one flower to another. This process, called pollination, allows plants to form seeds and grow new plants. Without bees and other pollinators, many of the foods we eat would not exist. Apples, almonds, cucumbers, and pumpkins all depend on bee pollination. [1] In short, bees are essential to both natural ecosystems and human food production, yet they often go unnoticed in our daily lives.

There are thousands of bee species worldwide. The honeybee is the best-known type, but bumblebees, mason bees, and many wild bees also pollinate plants. Some bees are generalists—they visit many kinds of flowers. Others specialize in certain plants. Together, different bee species help pollinate a wide variety of crops and wildflowers. [2] This diversity of bees ensures that pollination continues even when one species faces problems, keeping ecosystems and farms healthy and productive.

Sadly, bee populations have been declining in many parts of the world. Loss of habitat, pesticides, diseases, and climate change have all contributed to this decline. When bees disappear, crops that depend on them suffer. Farmers may see lower harvests, and some plants may not produce fruit at all. Scientists and farmers are working to protect bees by planting wildflowers, reducing pesticide use, and creating "bee hotels" for wild bees. [3] Protecting bees is not just about saving insects—it is about securing the food supply and the health of our environment for future generations.

Everyone can help bees thrive. Planting flowers that bloom at different times of the year provides food for bees from spring to fall. Avoiding pesticides in home gardens helps keep bees safe. Leaving some wild areas or bare soil in yards gives ground-nesting bees a place to live. Even a small balcony or windowsill garden can offer bees a place to rest and feed. [4] Small actions by individuals, when added together, can create a safer and more welcoming environment for bees in our neighborhoods and beyond.

Bees remind us that small creatures can have an enormous impact. The work they do—flying from flower to flower, transferring pollen—supports the growth of countless plants. As we learn more about their importance, we also learn how much we depend on them. [5] Taking care of bees means taking care of the natural world that sustains us all, one flower and one pollinator at a time.

选项

A. In short, bees are essential to both natural ecosystems and human food production, yet they often go unnoticed in our daily lives. B. This diversity of bees ensures that pollination continues even when one species faces problems, keeping ecosystems and farms healthy and productive. C. Protecting bees is not just about saving insects—it is about securing the food supply and the health of our environment for future generations. D. Small actions by individuals, when added together, can create a safer and more welcoming environment for bees in our neighborhoods and beyond. E. Taking care of bees means taking care of the natural world that sustains us all, one flower and one pollinator at a time. F. For example, in parts of China, farmers sometimes pollinate apple and pear trees by hand when there are not enough bees to do the job.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍蜜蜂采蜜授粉、列举依赖蜜蜂的作物（苹果、杏仁、黄瓜、南瓜），空后需总结蜜蜂的重要性与常被忽视。A的"essential to both natural ecosystems and human food production"与前文授粉及作物对应，"often go unnoticed in our daily lives"点明其被低估的地位。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前列举多种蜜蜂——蜜蜂、熊蜂、石巢蜂、野生蜂，以及泛化型与专一型，空后需总结多样性的作用。B的"This diversity of bees"与前文多种蜜蜂对应，"ensures that pollination continues even when one species faces problems"概括多样性带来的稳定性。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说明蜜蜂数量下降——栖息地丧失、农药、疾病、气候变化，以及保护举措，空后需升华保护蜜蜂的意义。C的"Protecting bees is not just about saving insects"与前文保护工作对应，"securing the food supply and the health of our environment for future generations"点明保护的人本与生态价值。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前列举个人可做之事——四季开花植物、避免农药、保留野生区域、阳台窗台花园，空后需总结个人行动 collectively 的影响。D的"Small actions by individuals, when added together"与前文个人举措对应，"create a safer and more welcoming environment"概括累积效果。

- [5] E：
    - **线索**：空前强调小生物大影响、蜜蜂工作支持无数植物、人类对蜜蜂的依赖，空后需收束全文。E的"Taking care of bees means taking care of the natural world that sustains us all"升华保护蜜蜂即保护人类赖以生存的自然，"one flower and one pollinator at a time"是全文的收尾升华。
- **干扰项分析**：
    - **F. For example, in parts of China, farmers sometimes pollinate apple and pear trees by hand when there are not enough bees to do the job.**：以For example开头，为具体替代授粉案例（中国人工授粉）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[3]易被误选因涉及蜜蜂不足与作物，但该空需总结保护蜜蜂的深层意义，而非人工授粉的个案描述。